

Lent: What Are You Giving Up? [B1]

Nei quaranta giorni che precedono la Pasqua, l'usanza è quella di rinunciare a qualcosa: nel 2026, è l'occasione giusta per disintossicarsi dal cellulare.

During the forty days of [Lent](#) (Sundays are excluded,) many people across the UK will be [giving something up](#): alcohol, cigarettes, [carbs](#)... Abstinence during [Lent](#) was originally a Catholic tradition, and England, Wales, and Scotland haven't officially been Catholic countries since the 1500s. In recent years, however, there seems to be a renewed interest in doing a springtime detox.

A NEW START

The word '[Lent](#)' comes from the Old German word for springtime and has the same etymological [roots](#) as the word '[lengthen](#)'. It is the time of year when the days are getting longer. In the Christian calendar, the day before [Lent](#) starts is called [Shrove Tuesday](#). It was the day when Catholics would confess their [sins](#) before [Lent](#) began. Rich foods were [forbidden](#) during [Lent](#), so [households](#) would [use up](#) eggs, butter and milk by making pancakes on this day. It's similar to the way that in Catholic countries Mardi Gras and carnival are an opportunity for a final indulgence before the restrictions of [Lent](#). In recent times, across the UK, Ireland, Australia, Canada, and New Zealand, many people eat pancakes on [Shrove Tuesday](#), which is now celebrated as the secular festival of Pancake Day. Current Affairs

Digital Addiction: What Happens When We Cannot Disconnect I social media e altre forme di intrattenimento digitale possono causare ansia, depressione e altri problemi di salute mentale. Uno specialista delle dipendenze approfondisce le cause e i sintomi di questo disturbo e spiega come evitarlo. Talitha Linehan , Molly Malcolm

SELF-DISCIPLINE

Historians generally agree that observing [Lent](#) became a shared Christian practice in 325 [CE](#). [Early on](#), [Lent](#) centred on [fasting](#), often in the form of the Black Fast. This extreme [fasting](#) allowed only one small meal after [sundown](#) and excluded meat, [dairy](#), alcohol, and sexual relations. The [aim](#) was to practice self-discipline and [reflect](#) on how Jesus spent forty days and nights in the desert before the crucifixion. But during the Protestant Reformation, which began in Germany in 1517 and [spread](#) across Northern Europe, many of the Catholic Church's practices, including [fasting](#) for [Lent](#), were criticised or even [banned](#). Though some Protestants continued to observe [Lent](#), it was in a more moderate form.

A MODERN LENT

Today, [Lent](#) often survives less as a religious obligation than as a secular personal challenge. People might give up sweets, meat, alcohol, or carbohydrates. Others try digital [fasting](#), sometimes called a 'digital detox', giving up or at least reducing social media, screen time and phone use. Wellness culture has [embraced Lent](#) as an opportunity for detox or reset, with apps and clinics promoting it as a time to lose weight or build healthier habits. [Lent](#), whether religious or secular, is still a season when less is more.

Glossary

- **Lent** = Quaresima
- **Shrove Tuesday** = Martedì Grasso (to shrive: confessare)
- **Early on** = all'inizio
- **fasting** = digiuno
- **reflect** = riflettere
- **banned** = vietare
- **sins** = peccati
- **forbidden** = vietare
- **CE** = d.C. (Common Era)
- **sundown** = tramonto, calar del sole
- **dairy** = latticini
- **aim** = obiettivo, scopo
- **embraced** = adottare, accogliere
- **carbs** = carboidrati
- **lengthen** = allungare
- **households** = famiglie, case
- **use up** = consumare, usare completamente
- **spread** = diffondersi, espandersi
- **giving something up** = rinunciare a qualcosa, smettere
- **roots** = radici